

WOODLAND DREAMS BASISBODY

LME BABY COLLECTION - WOODLAND DREAMS

A timeless, unisex basisbody in stockinette stitch: round neck, raglan sleeves, ribbing at the neck, cuffs and hem, and buttons at the crotch for easy nappy changes. Seven sizes, from 0-1 to 18-24 months. The basisbody is the foundation of the "Woodland Dreams" collection, designed to be combined with all six accessory patterns: lace collar, ruffle collar, Peter Pan collar, bib, i-cord suspenders and short vest.

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TIP: Read through the whole pattern and the size chart on page 4 before you start, and knit a 15 x 15 cm gauge swatch to check your tension, before casting on the body itself.

ABOUT THE WOODLAND DREAMS BASISBODY

THE FOUNDATION OF THE COLLECTION

The basisbody is the first piece in LME Woodland Dreams, a modular knitting collection in a Scandinavian, timeless style. The idea is simple: one well-fitting body, that can be built on with different collars, a bib, suspenders or a little vest, without knitting a new body for every outfit.

STYLE

Clean lines, soft transitions and calm natural colours: cream, linen, sand, oatmeal and beige. No fixed trim or decoration on the body itself, it is meant to be the quiet foundation that the colour and shape of the accessories are allowed to lift.

A ROOMY, NAPPY-FRIENDLY FIT

Knitted with a little extra width over the chest and good body length, so there is room for a nappy without the body pulling tight. Long sleeves all year round, and a set of buttons at the crotch make nappy changes quick, without undressing the whole baby.

MATERIALS

YARN

Sandnes Garn Alpakka (100% alpaca), or an equivalent yarn with the same gauge. Choose one of the collection's calm natural colours for the body itself: cream, linen, sand, oatmeal or beige.

YARN REQUIREMENTS

Size	Yarn amount
0-1 mnd	90-100 g
1-3 mnd	105-115 g
3-6 mnd	120-135 g
6-9 mnd	140-155 g
9-12 mnd	160-175 g
12-18 mnd	180-200 g
18-24 mnd	210-230 g

NEEDLES AND NOTIONS

Circular needle 4 mm (40 cm and 60 cm), plus double-pointed needles or a short circular needle 4 mm for the sleeves. Three small round wooden buttons for the crotch (and two extra small wooden buttons for the shoulder opening on the three smallest sizes). Stitch markers (at least 4, ideally in four different colours for the four raglan lines), a tapestry needle, and a 3 mm crochet hook for crocheting the buttonhole loops.

SIZE CHART

Finished measurements, measured lying flat. Choose size by chest measurement, or one size up for extra room to grow.

Size	Chest width	Neck-to-crotch length	Sleeve length	Neck opening
0-1 mnd	46.4 cm	25 cm	8.5 cm	21 cm
1-3 mnd	49.1 cm	27 cm	9.5 cm	22 cm
3-6 mnd	51.8 cm	30 cm	10.5 cm	23 cm
6-9 mnd	54.5 cm	33 cm	11.5 cm	24 cm
9-12 mnd	57.3 cm	36 cm	12.5 cm	25 cm
12-18 mnd	60.0 cm	39 cm	13.5 cm	26 cm
18-24 mnd	62.7 cm	42 cm	14.5 cm	27 cm

The measurements are the finished chest width (full circumference), i.e. including the roomy fit the pattern is calculated with, not the baby's actual chest measurement.

GAUGE AND DIFFICULTY LEVEL

GAUGE

22 stitches and 30 rounds in stockinette stitch = 10 x 10 cm, on 4 mm needles. This gauge is used in every calculation in the pattern. Always knit a swatch first: cast on 26 stitches, work stockinette stitch for approx. 12 cm, bind off and block lightly. If your gauge does not match, change to a smaller or larger needle until it does, not just to match the yarn.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL

Medium. You should be comfortable knitting in the round, increasing and decreasing, picking up stitches, and working simple buttonholes. No complicated stitch patterns, the whole body is stockinette stitch and rib.

ABBREVIATIONS

Norwegian knitting terms with the English terms alongside.

Norwegian	English	Meaning
r	K	rett
vr	P	vrangbord/vrang
m	st(s)	maske(r)
o	rnd	omgang
øk	inc	øk (ta opp én tilleggsmaske)
felle	dec	felle (strikk to masker sammen)
r-felling	k2tog	strikk 2 r sammen (hellende høyre)
vr-felling	ssk	løft av, løft av, strikk sammen (hellende venstre)
ta opp m	pick up sts	ta opp masker langs en kant
fell av	BO	fell av / bind off
legg opp	CO	legg opp masker
rettpinne	straight needle	rett/enkeltpinne
rundpinne	circular needle	rundpinne
strømpepinne	DPN	strømpepinne (dobbeltpiss)
maskemarkør	st marker	maskemarkør

TIPS

- Use four stitch markers in different colours for the four raglan lines, it makes it much easier to keep track as you go.
- Always knit a swatch, even if you "usually" get this gauge, alpaca behaves a little differently from wool.
- Count your stitches at every checkpoint marked in the pattern. It is easier to fix a mistake 10 rounds back than 40.

HOW THE BODY IS CONSTRUCTED

The body is knitted top-down, in one piece, with raglan sleeves. Four simple parts, in this order:

1. Neck and yoke

Cast on at the neck, work rib, increase four raglan lines evenly until the yoke width is reached.

2. Divide for sleeves and body

Put the sleeve stitches on hold, cast on a few new stitches under each arm, continue in the round on the body alone.

3. The body down to the crotch

Knit stockinette straight down, finish with rib and a button opening at the crotch.

4. The sleeves down to the cuff

Put the sleeve stitches back on the needle, knit around down the arm, finish with rib at the cuff.

PART 1: THE NECK OPENING

The body is cast on at the neck and knitted top-down. On the three smallest sizes (0-1, 1-3 and 3-6 months) it is cast on flat, with a small opening at the left shoulder that closes with two buttons, so the head passes through more easily. On the four largest sizes (6-9 to 18-24 months) it is cast on in the round, with no opening, since the neck is then wide enough on its own.

Example, 0-1 months: The three smallest sizes: cast on 38 stitches flat on a 4 mm circular needle (work back and forth, not in the round, for the first 7 rows). Place a stitch marker after stitch 18, after stitch 19, after stitch 37 and after stitch 38, these mark the four raglan lines (back-left sleeve, left sleeve-front, front-right sleeve, right sleeve-back).

Example, 6-9 months: The four largest sizes: cast on 40 stitches in the round on a 4 mm circular needle, place a marker for the start of the round. Place a stitch marker after stitch 20, after stitch 20, after stitch 40 and after stitch 40, as above.

Work k1, p1 rib for 7 rounds/rows.

The exact stitch count for your size is in the grading table on the next page.

PART 2: RAGLAN INCREASES

Switch to stockinette stitch. Now increase evenly along all four raglan lines, until the yoke width is reached. The construction is the same for every size, only the numbers change, see the grading table below.

Increase round (every 2nd round/row): increase 1 stitch right before and 1 stitch right after each of the four raglan markers (8 stitches increased in total per increase round). Knit plain, with no increases, on the round/row in between.

Size	Neck cast-on	Increase rounds	Rounds to yoke depth	Sts at yoke depth
0-1 mnd	38	8	16	102
1-3 mnd	36	9	18	108
3-6 mnd	42	9	18	114
6-9 mnd	40	10	20	120
9-12 mnd	46	10	20	126
12-18 mnd	44	11	22	132
18-24 mnd	50	11	22	138

Check: count your stitches. They should match the number in the "Sts at yoke depth" column for your size, before you move on to part 3.

PART 3: DIVIDE FOR SLEEVES AND BODY

Now the yoke is divided into two sleeves and a body. Do this the same way for every size, use your own row's stitch numbers from the table on the previous page.

Example with numbers for 0-1 months, use your own numbers from the table on the previous page.

- Knit across the 34 front stitches (stitches between the left and right raglan markers, front section).
- Put the next 17 stitches (left sleeve) on a holder or spare needle, to rest.
- Cast on 2 new stitches right over the sleeve gap, these give a little extra ease under the arm.
- Knit across the 34 back stitches.
- Put the next 17 stitches (right sleeve) on a holder or spare needle, to rest.
- Cast on 2 new stitches over the other sleeve gap.
- You now have 72 stitches on the needle, in the round, the body alone. Place a marker for the start of the round at centre back.

PART 4: THE BODY DOWN TO THE CROTCH

Knit stockinette stitch straight down, in the round, with no increasing or decreasing, until the body reaches the desired length. See the table below for how many rounds to work for your size.

Size	Body stitches	Rounds stockinette	Rounds rib at hem	Finished length
0-1 mnd	72	52	7	25 cm
1-3 mnd	76	56	7	27 cm
3-6 mnd	80	65	7	30 cm
6-9 mnd	84	72	7	33 cm
9-12 mnd	88	81	7	36 cm
12-18 mnd	92	88	7	39 cm
18-24 mnd	96	97	7	42 cm

Switch to k1, p1 rib and work 7 rounds. Bind off all stitches loosely in rib pattern, so the hem edge stays stretchy.

BUTTONS AT THE CROTCH

Work a 4-5 cm long placket at centre front, right above the rib hem, by knitting back and forth instead of in the round for the last few rounds before binding off. Edge both sides of the placket with 2 rows of garter stitch, then crochet three small loops (buttonholes) on one side with a 3 mm crochet hook, and sew three wooden buttons onto the other side, directly opposite the loops. The placket makes nappy changes quick without undressing the baby.

PART 5: THE SLEEVES

Put the sleeve stitches back onto the needle from the holder, one sleeve at a time. Also pick up the 2 stitches that were cast on under the arm in part 3, so you knit in the round in one piece.

Size	Sts per sleeve	Rounds stockinette	Rounds rib at cuff	Finished sleeve length
0-1 mnd	19	20	6	8.5 cm
1-3 mnd	20	22	6	9.5 cm
3-6 mnd	21	26	6	10.5 cm
6-9 mnd	22	28	6	11.5 cm
9-12 mnd	23	32	6	12.5 cm
12-18 mnd	24	34	6	13.5 cm
18-24 mnd	25	38	6	14.5 cm

Switch to k1, p1 rib and work 6 rounds. Bind off loosely in rib pattern. Repeat the same way for the other sleeve.

SHOULDER OPENING (0-1, 1-3 AND 3-6 MONTHS)

Only for the three smallest sizes. The four largest sizes skip straight from the sleeves to finishing on the next page.

The opening at the left shoulder (from the flat neck knitting in part 1) is edged with 2 rows of garter stitch on each side. Crochet two small loops (buttonholes) on the front edge with a 3 mm crochet hook, and sew two wooden buttons onto the back edge, directly opposite the loops. Button the shoulder closed once the body is finished and ready to put on.

FINISHING

- 1 Sew together the 2 stitches that were cast on under each arm, with a small, neat seam, so no hole is left.
- 2 Weave in all loose ends securely on the wrong side, and trim them short.
- 3 Sew on the buttons at the crotch and (for the three smallest sizes) at the shoulder, see part 4 and the shoulder opening page.
- 4 Lightly steam-block the body on the wrong side, avoid pressing directly on the ribbed edges, they should keep their stretch.
- 5 Finally, check that every button is securely attached, and that no loose threads or stitches can come undone.

SAFETY AND CARE

SAFETY

- Always use small, securely attached buttons, and sew them on with double thread, several times through each hole.
- Check the buttons regularly, especially after washing, and reattach them at the first sign of looseness.
- This pattern is not intended for children who put small objects in their mouth unsupervised, never leave a baby alone and unsupervised in the body during the first while of wearing it.
- All measurements and stitch counts in this pattern are calculated for a roomy, comfortable fit, not a tight safety fit, always follow current safety recommendations for children's clothing.

CARE INSTRUCTIONS

Hand wash gently in lukewarm water with wool wash, or machine wash on a wool cycle at 30 degrees. Press out the water, ease into shape, and dry lying flat on a towel. Avoid hanging the body up to dry, alpaca can stretch out of shape.

ALL DONE!

Congratulations, your basisbody is finished! It is made to be the foundation of the whole "Woodland Dreams" collection, ready to be combined with the collars, the bib, the suspenders or the vest.

THE REST OF THE COLLECTION

- Lace collar, a loose collar that fastens at the back.
- Ruffle collar, the same fastening, a little more romantic.
- Peter Pan collar, a classic rounded collar.
- Bib, tied with an i-cord or a button.
- I-cord suspenders, the collection's signature piece, adjustable and crossing at the back.
- Short vest, with wooden buttons at the front, worn over the body.
- Woodland Fluffy Skirt, a crocheted skirt made to match the body.

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